Lattice routes to the prime-field ECDLP: what the lattices are, which ones can be written down, and what each is worth

Status: evaluation note, 2026-10-23. Literature review plus derivations; no measurement, no new attack claim, no scoreboard change. Classed under the repository's rules as a direction assessment, like `RESEARCH_REPRESENTATION_STRUCTURE.md`: it closes nothing that a measured row holds open, and it declines to open a campaign.

Question asked (owner, 2026-10-23): evaluate approaches that use lattices for the elliptic-curve discrete logarithm problem; the intuition offered was that a hard problem like the ECDLP "can be represented in high-dimensional space", that this seems promising, and that it is under-represented in the literature.

Visuals: `routes.svg` (the map of lattices attached to an instance) and `exponents.svg` (derived cost exponents of §6, values in `exponents.json`); PDF of this note with both: `REPORT.pdf`.

Companions: `RESEARCH_ECDLP_STATE_OF_THE_ART.md`, `RESEARCH_NZMS_AMS_AUSTMS_2024_IDEAS.md` §4.2, `../lattice-hnp/RESEARCH_HNP_LANDSCAPE.md`, `../lattice-hnp/RESEARCH_GLV_HNP_PHASE2.md` §8b, `crypto-autoresearcher:knowledge/findings/KN-FIND-009.md` (witness lattices), `crypto-autoresearcher:knowledge/findings/KN-FIND-003.md` … `KN-FIND-011.md` (function-field xedni line).

TL;DR

1. **The premise is half right.** The ECDLP does have exact lattice representations, several of them, and the group `E(F_p)` of an ordinary curve literally is a lattice quotient: `E(F_p) ≅ R/(π−1)R` as a module over the endomorphism ring `R`, which has Z-rank 2 (Lenstra 1996, Theorem 1(a), read from the paper). What is wrong is "high-dimensional": every lattice that an instance `(E, P, Q = [k]P)` carries intrinsically has rank 2 (or 4 over `Z[τ]`), because `End(E)` of an ordinary curve has rank 2 and `F_p` has no proper subfield to descend along. The high-dimensional objects one can build (witness lattices of rank `2r`, Mordell–Weil lattices of lifts, Coppersmith lattices for summation polynomials) are high-dimensional by construction, not by structure, and each pays for its dimension in a way §4–§6 make explicit.
2. **The dividing line is "writable without `k`".** Every lattice whose short vectors encode `k` (the relation lattice `L_k`, the witness lattice `W_r(k)`, Lenstra's coordinates) has a basis that is polynomial-time equivalent to the discrete log itself the repository already holds the certificate and derivation for the witness case (KN-FIND-009). Lattice reduction needs a basis to start from, so these lattices cannot be reduced, only sampled, and Pollard rho is exactly a `θ(√N)` sampler of `L_k`. Every lattice one can write from public data (the GLV lattice, the `Z[τ]`-net zero lattice) is `k`-independent and yields at most the automorphism constant `√#Aut(E) ≤ √6`, or a two-dimensional baby-step giant-step that is still `θ(√N)` (§4.2 of the NZMS note).
3. **Lattices are decisive exactly where a linear equation over `Z/N` exists**, which the group law never provides but a protocol or a side channel does: the hidden-number problem family (Boneh–Venkatesan 1996; Howgrave-Graham–Smart 2001; Nguyen–Shparlinski 2002; EC-HNP of Boneh–Halevi–Howgrave-Graham 2001; Shani 2017). This repository measures those routes (`src/cryptanalysis/hnp_ecdsa.rs`, `multi_key_hnp.rs`, the GLV-aware lattice at 12/17/20 bits). That is why the lattice literature around elliptic curves looks "under-represented" for the pure ECDLP: it is concentrated where it works, and the pure problem offers no linear handle. The under-representation is a consequence of a barrier, not an oversight.
4. **The one route that looks like a genuine lattice attack on the pure problem, Coppersmith-style point decomposition over a small-`x` factor base, is closed by a derivation (§6):** the root region a Coppersmith lattice can reach for the summation polynomial `S_{m+1}` is `∏ X_i ≤ p^{θ_m}` with `θ_m = 2/((m+1)·2^{m−1})`, which caps the factor base at `B ≤ p^{θ_m/m}` and the relation-collection cost at `p^{1 − (m−1)θ_m/m}`: `p^{5/6}` at `m = 2`, rising towards `p^1`. Matching rho's `p^{1/2}` would need `θ ≥ m/(2(m−1)) ≥ 1/2`, and for `m = 2` it would need `θ ≥ 1`, the point at which the "small root" is no longer distinguished from the other solutions and the lattice step is the decomposition problem. No Coppersmith-type method reaches `p^{1/2}` for a polynomial of degree 2 or more. This agrees with Galbraith–Gaudry's survey verdict that over prime fields "there is no known efficient decomposition algorithm" for Semaev's small-abscissa base, and sharpens it to a quantitative ceiling.
5. **The lifting route (xedni, Mordell–Weil lattices) is refuted in the literature and exhausted at toy scale here.** Jacobson–Koblitz– Silverman–Stein–Teske (2000) show an absolute bound on the coefficients of any relation among lifted points, so dependence vanishes as `p` grows. The repository's function-field variant (GOAL-XEDN-001/002/003, GOAL-ICLIFT-001, all `completed`) found ∞-norm-1 Mordell–Weil relations only at `p ≤ 31` and settled its density gate exactly at rate `p^{−3}` (KN-FIND-008); its own goal text forbids presenting it as an attack improvement.
6. **Recommendation.** Do not open a lattice campaign on the pure prime-field ECDLP. Two bounded items are worth doing (§7): a toy measurement of `θ_2` that would falsify §6 if Coppersmith on `S_3` reached beyond `p^{1/3}`, and a short derivation turning the "writable lattices are `k`-independent" observation into a lemma

under the R1–R5 admissibility test. Keep lattice work where it is live: the HNP / leakage line, and the constant-factor automorphism folds already in the index-calculus notes.

1. The question, made precise

"Represent the ECDLP in a high-dimensional space" can mean four different things, and they have four different answers.

reading	the object	what it is worth	section
(a) the group is a lattice quotient	$E(\mathbb{F}_p) \cong \mathbb{R}/(\pi-1)R$, $R = \mathrm{End}(E)$ of rank 2	exact, but the coordinate map is a 2-D DLP ($\theta(\sqrt{N})$)	§4.3
(b) the relations form a lattice	$L_k = \{(a,b) : aP + bQ = O\}$, $\det N$; rank-2r witness lattices	a basis ⇔ the log; reduction cannot start; rho samples it	§4.1, §4.2
(c) the scalar lives in a lattice	GLV lattice $\{(a,b) : a + b\lambda \equiv 0 \bmod N\}$; $\mathbb{Z}[\tau]$-net zero lattice	writable; constant factor $\sqrt{\#\mathrm{Aut}}$, or a 2-D BSGS at $\theta(\sqrt{N})$	§4.4, §4.5
(d) the decomposition or the lift is a lattice problem	Coppersmith lattices for S_{m+1}; Mordell–Weil lattices of lifts	writable with extra input; ceilings derived (§6) or refuted (JKSST)	§5, §6

A fifth reading, (e) a linear equation over $\mathbb{Z}/N$ from outside the group, is the hidden-number problem, where lattices are the right tool and the repository already works (§5.4). It is not the pure ECDLP.

The barrier behind all of (a)–(d) is Shoup's generic-group bound ($\Omega(\sqrt{N})$ for any algorithm that touches the group only through its operation and equality) together with the observation, made precise in §3, that a lattice can only be reduced if its basis can be written down, and every basis that depends on k is k.

2. What the repository already holds (checked first)

- **Witness lattices, certificate level.** KN-FIND-009 (crypto-autoresearcher, 2026-07-28): for a $j = 0$ curve with eigenvalues $\{1, \lambda_2, \lambda_3\}$ of the order-3 automorphism, the eigenvalue-augmented witness lattice $W_r(k)$ has an ∞-norm-1 vector $(1,1,1,0,\ldots)$ for every $r \geq 3$ and every k (Vieta: $1 + \lambda_2 + \lambda_3 \equiv 0 \bmod N$), against a Minkowski prediction of $N^{1/(2r)}$; the on-curve relation $P + \varphi(P) + \varphi^2(P) = O$ yields no logarithm. Derivation 2 there: writing any basis of $W_r(k)$ is polynomial-time equivalent to solving the instance, with no LLL involved (a one-dimensional nullspace mod N reads k off). Derivation 3: the degeneracy of these lattices is governed by short eigenvalue relations, not by the rank of $\mathrm{End}(E)$.
- **$\mathbb{Z}[\tau]$-net zero lattice.** RESEARCH_NZMS_AMS_AUSTMS_2024_IDEAS.md §4.2: the zero set $\Lambda = \{(\alpha,\beta) \in \mathbb{Z}[\tau]^2 : \alpha + k\beta \equiv 0 \bmod \pi\}$ has Z-rank 4 and index r; Minkowski gives (α,β) with $N(\alpha), N(\beta) \ll r^{1/2}$, but finding it is a two-dimensional baby-step giant-step, so it stays generic.
- **Function-field xedni.** GOAL-XEDN-001/002/003 and GOAL-ICLIFT-001 (all `status: completed`); findings KN-FIND-003, −004, −005, −008, −010, −011. Mordell–Weil relations of ∞-norm 1 were found on non-isotrivial surfaces at $p \in \{7, 13, 19, 31\}$ by full enumeration; the lift-probability gate was settled exactly as $P_{\mathrm{lift}}(p) = (1 - 2/p + p^{-3})/(2p^3)$ (KN-FIND-008), i.e. codimension 3. Every record is marked toy-scale and `support_scoped`; GOAL-ICLIFT-001's objective states that neither route "is permitted to be presented as an attack improvement".
- **HNP line, measured.** `../lattice-hnp/`: the Boneh–Venkatesan basis in `src/cryptanalysis/hnp_ecdsa.rs`, multi-key HNP, Bleichenbacher; the GLV-aware k_1-only-leak lattice implemented and measured over 3000 instances at 12, 17 and 20 bits (RESEARCH_GLV_HNP_PHASE2.md §8b); the secp256k1 "LLL degeneracy" traced to floating-point Gram–Schmidt defects and re-run (`research/lll_degeneracy_rerun_20261016/`). All of it needs leaked nonce bits; none of it touches the pure ECDLP.
- **Representation test.** RESEARCH_REPRESENTATION_STRUCTURE.md: every attack that ever beat the generic bound transferred the problem into a category with a non-generic algorithm, licensed by a specific published algebraic object (a subfield, a small embedding degree, trace 1, a torsion image). Its R1–R5 test is applied to each lattice route in §4–§5.
- **Attack matrix.** docs/ECDLP_ATTACK_MATRIX.md row 22 lists the only lattice entry: biased / partial-nonce HNP, "protocol" class.
- **Knowledge corpus.** `crypto-autoresearcher:knowledge/literature/` holds KN-LIT-020/021 (xedni and its analysis), KN-LIT-043/044/045 (HNP, Nguyen–Shparlinski, lattice attacks on signatures), KN-LIT-037 (Coppersmith), and the LWE/NTRU lattice-cryptanalysis spine (BKZ 2.0, sieving, G6K), which is about lattice problems, not the ECDLP.
- **Coppersmith on S_3, already measured (correction, 2026-10-23).** The first version of this note missed three records, found while building the §7 falsifier: RESEARCH_PRIME_FIELD_BREAKTHROUGH_PROGRAM.md §3.2–§3.3

(Probe B: the JM basic lattice on S_3 at 40 bits, "≥ 2 rows vanish" to $\delta = 0.12$–0.14 and Howgrave-Graham to 0.10; Probe C: extended shifts and the symmetric (e_1, e_2) lattice, same threshold), §2.2's derived $2/(m(m+1)d)$ limits $1/6, 1/24, 1/80$, and `research/lit2026_w10_s5_coppersmith_20261011/` (an exact min-cut optimiser over all monomial sets in the box, reproducing $1/18, 1/10, 0.119$ at $\ell = 1, 2, 3$ and the $1/6$ limit for S_3, and closing the S_5 route at $1/80$). §6's $\theta_m = 2/((m+1)\cdot 2^{m-1})$ is the same quantity as that $2/(m(m+1)d)$ with $d = 2^{m-1}$ and the per-variable β doubled to the product exponent, so the derivation was already in the repository and already measured at one size and one multiplicity each. The original sentence below ("What was missing is ... the Coppersmith ceiling (§6)") is kept as written and is wrong on that point; what §6 adds is the cost-exponent consequence ($p^{5/6}$ relation collection and the $\theta \geq m/(2(m-1))$ parity condition), not the root bound.

So the repository has already measured the two lattice routes that can be measured at all (HNP with leakage, function-field lifting at toy scale) and certified the k-dependence obstruction for witness lattices. What was missing is the map (this note's §4), the Coppersmith ceiling (§6), and a one-page answer to "why not lattices".

3. The barrier, stated once

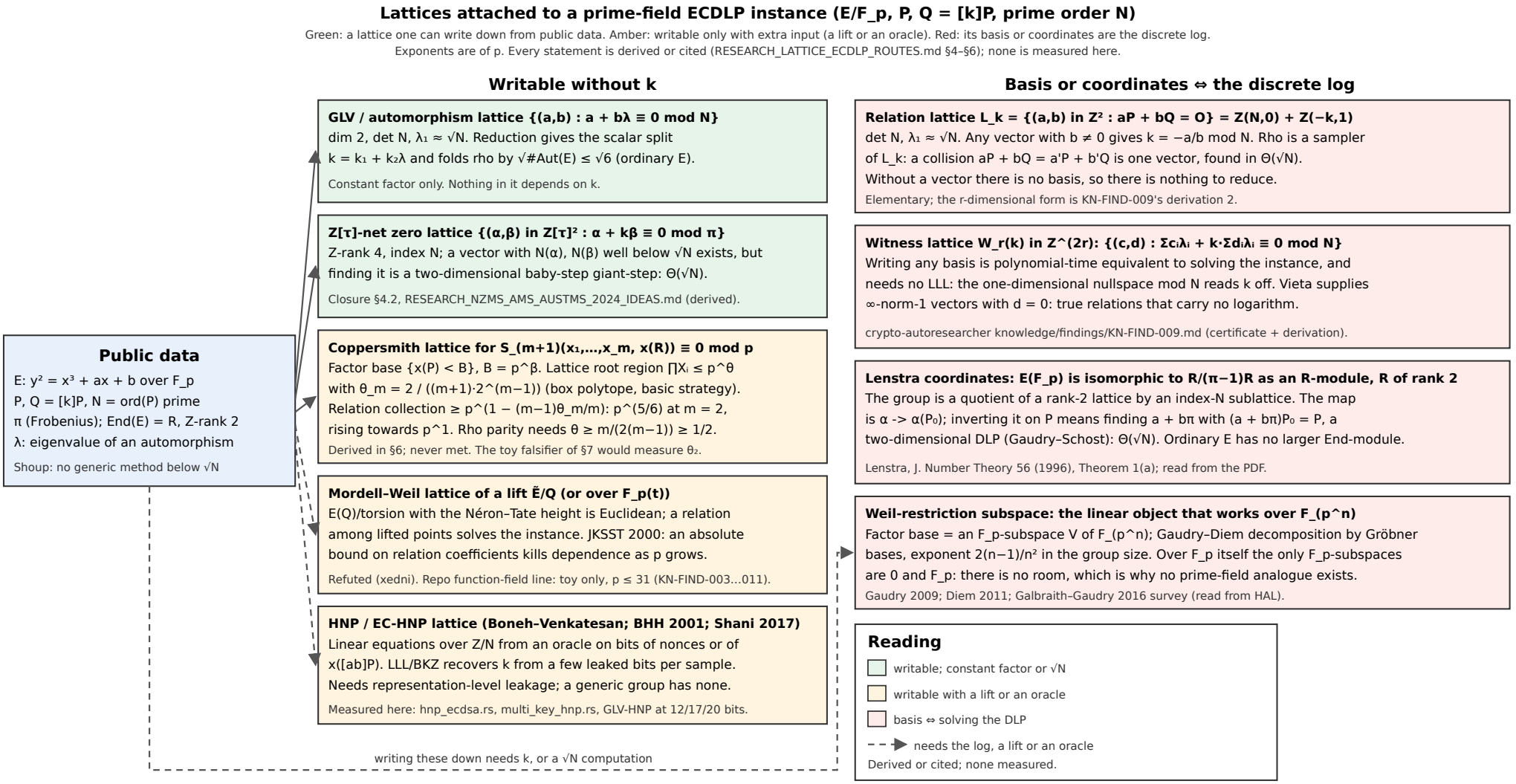
Let $G = \langle P \rangle \subset E(F_p)$ have prime order N, $Q = [k]P$.

Lemma A (bases are logs). Let $L \subset Z^d$ be a full-rank lattice, computable from (E, P, Q) in polynomial time as a set (membership is decidable from the group law), such that some vector of L determines k by a polynomial-time map. If L is the kernel of a homomorphism $Z^d \to Z/N$ (every relation lattice is), then from any basis of L one reads k in polynomial time without lattice reduction: the annihilator of L in $(Z/N)^d$ is cyclic of order N, generated by the row vector of character values, and k is a ratio of two of its coordinates. Conversely a basis can be written from k. Hence writing a basis is polynomial-time equivalent to solving the instance. This is derivation 2 of KN-FIND-009 for $W_r(k)$; for $L_k = \{(a,b) : a + bk \equiv 0 \bmod N\} = Z(N,0) \oplus Z(-k,1)$ it is immediate.

Consequence. Lattice reduction (LLL, BKZ, sieving) takes a basis and returns short vectors. On a relation lattice there is no basis to give it, so there is nothing for it to shorten. What can be done is to sample vectors of L_k: a Pollard rho collision $aP + bQ = a'P + b'Q$ is the vector $(a - a', b - b') \in L_k$, found after $\theta(\sqrt{N})$ group operations. Rho is a sampler of the relation lattice, and Shoup's bound says no generic sampler is faster.

Lemma B (writable lattices are k-independent). A lattice whose basis is computable from (E, P, Q) without a $\sqrt{N}$ computation cannot have k in its basis, hence its reduced vectors are functions of (E, P, Q) that every instance with the same (E, P) shares. Such a lattice can encode structure of the curve (the automorphism eigenvalue λ, the Frobenius π), and the only way that structure has ever fed an attack is through the transfer pattern of `RESEARCH_REPRESENTATION_STRUCTURE.md` or through a constant-factor fold of a generic walk. (Proposed as a lemma; the one-line proof is that a basis is a function of its inputs. The content is in what follows: whether some k-independent lattice licenses a transfer. §4 finds none.)

Lemma B is why "which lattice?" is the whole question. §4 goes through every lattice an instance carries; the diagram `routes.svg` is the same list drawn.



Source: routes.svg (hand-written). Companion graph: exponents.svg, drawn from exponents.json. 2026-10-23.

Figure 1: The lattices attached to a prime-field ECDLP instance, split by whether a basis can be written without the log (source: routes.svg).

4. The lattices an instance carries

4.1 The relation lattice `L_k` (rank 2, unwritable)

`L_k = {(a,b) ∈ Z² : aP + bQ = O} = Z(N,0) ⊕ Z(−k,1)`, `det L_k = N`, `λ₁(L_k) ≈ √N` for random `k`. A reduced basis has two vectors of norm about √N; any one with `b ≠ 0` gives `k = −a/b mod N`. **Verdict:** a basis is the log (Lemma A). Sampling it is rho. Nothing to do.

4.2 Witness lattices `W_r(k)` (rank `2r`, unwritable, degenerate)

Augmenting with endomorphism eigenvalues (`λ_i` of `φ ∈ End(E)` acting on `G`) gives `W_r(k) = {(c,d) ∈ Z^{2r} : Σ c_i λ_i + k Σ d_i λ_i ≡ 0 mod N}`. This is the "high-dimensional" lattice one gets by adding structure, and KN-FIND-009 shows two things about it: its basis is still the log (Lemma A), and its first minimum is not the Minkowski `N^{1/(2r)}` but 1, because the eigenvalues satisfy short integer relations (Vieta), and those short vectors have `d = 0` and carry no logarithm. **Verdict:** closed at certificate level in the repository. Adding dimensions added degenerate short vectors, not information.

4.3 Lenstra coordinates (rank 2, the coordinate map is a 2-D DLP)

Lenstra (1996), Theorem 1(a): for `E/k` over a finite field with Frobenius `π ∉ Z`, `R = End_k(E)` has Z-rank 2 and `E(l) ≅ R/R(π^n − 1)` as `R`-modules for `l/k` of degree `n`. So `E(F_p) ≅ R/(π−1)R`: the group is the quotient of the rank-2 lattice `R` by the index-`N(π−1) = #E(F_p)` sublattice `(π−1)R`. The isomorphism is `α ↦ α(P₀)` for a module generator `P₀`. To use it one needs the inverse map on `P` and `Q`, i.e. `a + bπ ∈ R` with `(a + bπ)P₀ = P`: a two-dimensional discrete logarithm in the `Z[π]`-module, which Gaudry–Schost solves in `θ(√N)` and nothing solves faster (it is a generic problem on a rank-2 abelian group). **Verdict:** exact, pretty, and generic. It also shows there is no "higher-dimensional End-module" to look for on an ordinary curve: the rank is 2. (Theorem 1(b), `π ∈ Z` with `R` of rank 4, is the supersingular case over suitable extension fields, which MOV already breaks.)

4.4 The GLV / automorphism lattice (rank 2, writable, constant factor)

For a curve with an efficient automorphism `φ` of eigenvalue `λ` on `G`, `L_λ = {(a,b) : a + bλ ≡ 0 mod N}` is writable from the curve alone; Gauss reduction gives the GLV decomposition `k = k₁ + k₂λ` with `|k_i| ≈ √N`, and the same lattice is what folds rho by `√#Aut(E)` (Duursma–Gaudry–Morain 1999; Wiener–Zuccherato 1999 for Koblitz). `#Aut(E) ≤ 6` for ordinary curves, so the fold is at most √6. This repository's index-calculus notes use the same object as the "fold" of endomorphism- invariant factor bases (`../index-calculus/RESEARCH_GLV_INVARIANT_FACTOR_BASES.md`). **Verdict:** live, used, and a constant.

4.5 The `Z[τ]`-net zero lattice (rank 4, writable up to a 2-D BSGS)

Covered by the NZMS note §4.2: short vectors exist by Minkowski; finding them is a two-dimensional baby-step giant-step at `θ(√N)`. **Verdict:** generic. (Rank 4 here is `Z[τ]²` , two copies of a rank-2 ring; it is the rank-2 ceiling of §4.3 twice, not a way around it.)

4.6 The Weil-restriction subspace (the linear object that does work, over `F_{p^n}`)

Over an extension field, the factor base of Gaudry (2009) and Diem (2011) is an `F_p`-linear subspace `V ⊂ F_{p^n}` of dimension `n'`, decomposition is a Gröbner-basis solve of the Weil-descended summation polynomial, and the exponent in the group size is `2(n−1)/n²` (Gaudry's `Õ(q^{2−2/n})` over `F_{q^n}`), below rho's `1/2` from `n = 3` on. This is the only "linear subspace" structure that has ever lowered the ECDLP exponent, and it is exactly the structure `F_p` lacks: the only `F_p`-subspaces of `F_p` are `0` and `F_p`. **Verdict:** the honest version of "high-dimensional representation" exists, is called Weil descent, and has no prime-field instance. (The repository's Diem-descent and Koblitz notes are this route; see `../index-calculus/RESEARCH_DIEM_DESCENT.md`.)

5. Routes that need extra input

5.1 Lifting to characteristic zero: xedni and Mordell–Weil lattices

Silverman's xedni calculus (1999) lifts `r` combinations of `P, Q` to `Q`-points on a lift `Ẽ/Q` and hopes they are linearly dependent in `Ẽ(Q)`; a dependence reduces to a relation in `E(F_p)` and solves the instance. `Ẽ(Q)/tors` with the Néron–Tate height is a Euclidean lattice, so "find the dependence" is a short-vector search in the Mordell–Weil lattice given its Gram matrix, and this is the one place where the ECDLP meets lattice reduction in the strict sense. Jacobson–Koblitz–Silverman–Stein– Teske (2000; read from the PDF) show that "asymptotically the algorithm is virtually certain to fail, because of an absolute bound on the size of the coefficients of a relation satisfied by the lifted points", and that at small `p` "the odds against finding a suitable lifting are prohibitively high" (their §4 states the theorem, §5 the experiments at `r = 2, 3, 4`). Huang–Raskind's signature calculus (2009) is a formalism over number fields with global duality; its ECDLP equivalence rests on heuristics and no cost

advantage is claimed. Galbraith–Gaudry (2016; read from HAL): "the paper [72] analysed the algorithm and explained why this approach is not likely to be successful. We do not discuss it further."

The repository's function-field variant replaces `Q` by `F_p(t)` (an elliptic surface) so that heights are degrees and the Mordell–Weil lattice is exactly computable; it found ∞-norm-1 relations at `p ≤ 31` and an exact lift-rate of codimension 3. Nothing in it moved past toy scale, and the coefficient bound of JKSST transfers (KN-FIND-004, "coefficient-bound transfer past μ_3 supported"). **Verdict:** refuted in the literature; the repository's own line is complete and scoped to toy support.

5.2 Coppersmith lattices for point decomposition

The one route that is a lattice attack on the pure prime-field problem. Treated in §6; the verdict is a derived ceiling of `p^{5/6}` on relation collection.

5.3 Lattices inside index calculus (the linear-algebra stage)

Relations live in `Z^{|F|}` and their kernel is the lattice of §4.1 in `|F|` dimensions; the final solve is over `Z/N`, not over `Z`, and sparse Wiedemann / structured Gaussian elimination is the right tool. Lattice reduction on relation vectors to shrink coefficients before elimination is occasionally used in NFS; it changes constants in the linear algebra, and the linear algebra is not the bottleneck of any prime-field index calculus in this repository (the decomposition is). **Verdict:** no exponent, and not the bottleneck. Lattice sieving in the NFS sense needs a linear `(a,b)`-plane of candidates, which the small-`x` factor base does not have (the abscissa of $P_1 + P_2$ is a rational function, not a linear form, of the abscissae of P_1, P_2; Galbraith–Gaudry: "the elliptic group law is deeply incompatible with the multiplication of the integers representing the abscissae").

5.4 Hidden-number problems (the route that works, with an oracle)

Given an oracle that returns a few bits of `k_i` for many `(h_i, r_i, s_i)` ECDSA signatures, or of `x([ab]P)` for many `(aP, bP)`, the unknown enters a linear equation over `Z/N`, the Boneh–Venkatesan lattice has the secret as a close vector, and LLL/BKZ recovers it with a handful of leaked bits per sample (Howgrave-Graham–Smart 2001; Nguyen–Shparlinski 2002/2003). The elliptic-curve HNP (Boneh–Halevi– Howgrave-Graham 2001) has the same shape with the group law replacing modular addition, and Shani (2017) proved that about 5/6 of the most significant bits of the `x`-coordinate of an ECDH key are as hard as the whole key, with later Coppersmith-based heuristic improvements (Xu–Sarkar–Wang–Hu 2022). **Verdict:** this is where lattices on elliptic curves are decisive, and it is the repository's measured lattice line. The oracle is representation-level leakage; the generic group has none, so it does not touch the pure problem. Multi-dimensional versions of the HNP (the repository's GLV-aware k_1-only leak) still need the leak.

5.5 Quantum post-processing

Ekerå–Håstad-style lattice post-processing of Shor's ECDLP output is lattice reduction on the classical side of a quantum algorithm; it is orthogonal to a classical attack and is not evaluated here.

6. Derivation: the Coppersmith ceiling on small-x decomposition

Setup. `E/F_p`, `G` of prime order `N ≈ p`. Factor base `F = {P ∈ G : 0 ≤ x(P) < B}`, `B = p^β`, `|F| ≈ B` (each abscissa carries 0 or 2 points, on average 1). A relation is a decomposition `R = P₁ + … + P_m`, `P_i ∈ F`, of a random `R = [a]P + [b]Q`; Semaev's summation polynomial gives the condition `S_{m+1}(x₁, …, x_m, x(R)) ≡ 0 (mod p)`, of degree `2^{m−1}` in each `x_i`. Standard heuristics (Gaudry 2009; this repository's boundary ledger):

- a random `R` decomposes with probability `≈ B^m / (m!·N)`, so collecting `≈ |F| = B` relations takes `T_rel ≈ B · m! ·N / B^m = m!·p / B^{m−1}` decomposition attempts, each costing one lattice call `C_lat`;
- the linear algebra on a `B × B` sparse matrix of row weight `m` costs `≈ m·B²` operations mod `N`.

The lattice step. To decompose by lattice reduction, one runs a Coppersmith-type method on `f(x₁,…,x_m) = S_{m+1}(x₁,…,x_m, x(R)) mod p` and asks it to return the root with all `|x_i| < X_i = B`. Such a method reaches roots in a region `∏ X_i ≤ p^{θ}` for a `θ` that depends on the Newton polytope of `f`. For `S_{m+1}` the polytope is contained in the box `[0, d]^m` with `d = 2^{m−1}`, and the leading monomial is `(x₁⋯x_m)^d`. The basic strategy of Jochemsz–May (2006) with shift bound `t` uses the monomial sets `M_k = {i ∈ [0, dt]^m : i_j ≥ kd for all j}`, the shift polynomials `x^{i − kd·1} f^k p^{t−k}` for `i ∈ M_k \ M_{k+1}`, and the determinant condition `∏_{i ∈ M_0} X^{|i|} · p^{Σ_k (t−k)(|M_k| − |M_{k+1}|)} < p^{t·|M_0|}` (symmetric bounds `X_i = X`). With `|M_k| = (d(t−k)+1)^m`, the `p`-exponent telescopes to `t|M_0| − Σ_{k≥1} |M_k|`, so the condition reads `X^{Σ_{i∈M_0}|i|} < p^{Σ_{k≥1}|M_k|}`. Asymptotically in `t`, `Σ_{i∈M_0}|i| ≈ (dt)^m · m·dt/2` and `Σ_{k≥1}|M_k| ≈ d^m t^{m+1}/(m+1)`, hence

```
X^m  <  p^{ 2 / ((m+1)·d) },      i.e.     θ_m = 2 / ((m+1)·2^{m−1}).
```

Checks: `m = 1` gives Coppersmith's univariate `X < p^{1/d}`; `m = 2, d = 2` gives `XY < p^{1/3}`, Coppersmith's bivariate heuristic bound for degree 2 in each variable. The extended strategy of Jochemsz–May and the symmetry of `S_{m+1}` change constants inside the lattice, not the `1/d` scaling, and the method is heuristic in the usual sense (the reduced polynomials must be algebraically independent). Two ceilings bracket it:

- **Uniqueness ceiling `θ ≤ 1`.** When `∏ X_i ≥ p` the congruence has `≈ ∏ X_i / p ≥ 1` expected solutions in the box, the sought root is not the small one, and the lattice step is the decomposition problem itself.
- **Coppersmith ceiling `θ_m`** as derived.

Cost. The lattice reaches the decomposition only if `B^m ≤ p^{θ_m}`, so `β ≤ θ_m/m`, and then

```
e_rel(m) = 1 − (m−1)·θ_m/m          (attempts; each one a lattice call)
e_la(m)  = 2·θ_m/m                  (sparse linear algebra)
```

m	θ_m	β_max	e_rel	e_la	θ needed for e_rel ≤ 1/2
2	1/3	1/6	**5/6**	1/3	1
3	1/8	1/24	11/12	1/12	3/4
4	1/20	1/80	77/80	1/40	2/3
5	1/48	1/240	59/60	1/120	5/8
6	1/112	1/672	667/672	1/336	3/5

(`exponents.json`; graph `exponents.svg`, left panel the exponents against rho's `1/2`, right panel `θ_m` against the `θ` rho-parity needs.)

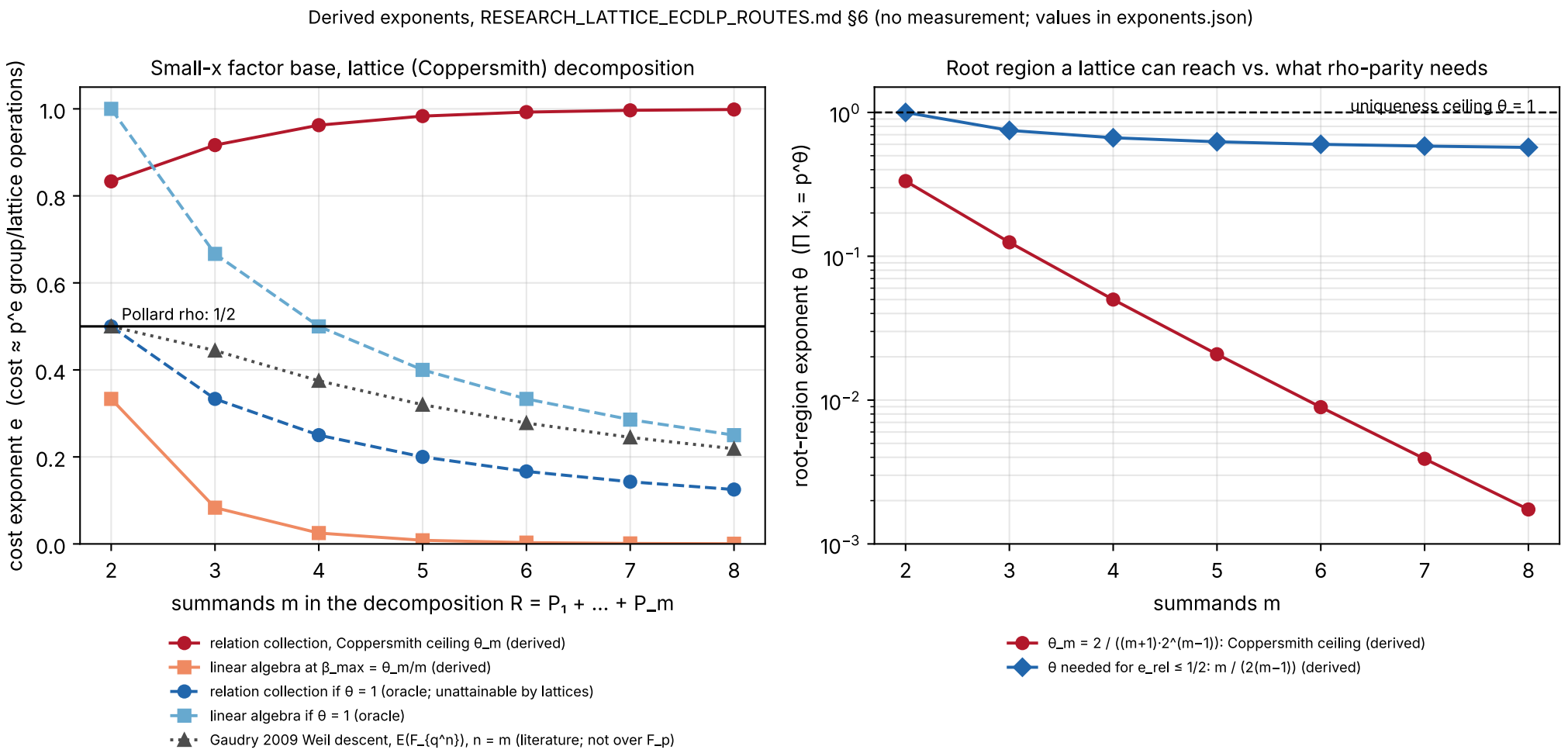


Figure 2: Derived cost exponents of the small-x Coppersmith decomposition route against Pollard rho (left) and the root-region exponent a lattice reaches against the one rho parity needs (right). Values from exponents.json; nothing measured.

Reading. The best case is $m = 2$ at $p^{5/6}$ lattice calls, each a reduction of a lattice of dimension $(2t+1)^2$ in $\approx 2t \cdot \log p$-bit entries, against rho's $p^{1/2}$ curve additions. Adding summands makes it worse, because the degree 2^{m-1} of S_{m+1} shrinks the root region faster than the extra summands enlarge the decomposable set. Rho parity needs $\theta \geq m/(2(m-1))$: at $m = 2$ that is $\theta \geq 1$, the uniqueness ceiling, so even a perfect lattice method would have to solve the decomposition problem outright; for every m it is at least $1/2$, and no Coppersmith- type method reaches $p^{1/2}$ on a polynomial of degree ≥ 2. The "oracle" rows of the graph ($\theta = 1$) are the standard statement that a decomposition oracle would make index calculus beat rho from $m \geq 5$; they are drawn only to show how far the lattice ceiling is from it.

Status of the derivation. Derived, not measured; heuristic at the level of every Coppersmith analysis; the box polytope is an upper estimate of S_{m+1}'s support, so θ_m is an upper bound on what the basic strategy gives for the actual polynomial (the real bound can only be smaller). It agrees with Galbraith–Gaudry's qualitative verdict and with the repository's position that no prime-field index calculus has rho's exponent (`../index-calculus/RESEARCH_IC_BOUNDARY_LEDGER.md`). No `identity.certificate` is shipped because no algebraic identity is claimed; the one measurable statement is $\theta_2 \approx 1/3$, and §7 says how to test it.

7. What, if anything, to do

1. **Toy falsifier for §6 (bounded; optional).** Implement Coppersmith's bivariate method for $S_3(x_1, x_2, x(R)) \bmod p$ in Rust on the existing lattice code (`src/cryptanalysis/lattice.rs`), at $p \approx 2^{20}$–2^{40}, and measure the largest β at which the planted decomposition is recovered against $\theta_{2/2} = 1/6$. Pre-registered stop rule: if recovery holds at $\beta > 1/4$ (i.e. $\theta > 1/2$) across sizes, §6 is wrong and this note is corrected; otherwise the route is closed at measured level. Cost: one session. It cannot produce a speedup, so it never reaches the IC leaderboard; it is a check on a derivation. Class: boundary measurement. **Done (2026-10-23):** `research/coppersmith_s3_theta2_20261023/`, protocol frozen before the run, instrument `examples/coppersmith_s3_theta2_falsifier.rs` (full pipeline: lattice, LLL, resultant root extraction, candidates checked against S_3), four sizes 24–56 bits, $\ell \leq 3$, β to 0.34, positive and negative controls. The verdict against the stop rule is in that study's `REPORT.md`.
2. **Lemma B as a derivation record.** State and prove, under the R1–R5 test of `RESEARCH_REPRESENTATION_STRUCTURE.md`, that a lattice computable from (E, P, Q) in time $o(\sqrt{N})$ is k-independent, and that a k-independent lattice feeds an attack only through a transfer object or an automorphism fold. One page; closes the "which lattice?" question for future proposals in four lines, the way the NZMS note's closures do.
3. **Do not open** a campaign on lattice reduction for the pure prime-field ECDLP: every writable lattice is k-independent (Lemma B), every k-dependent one has a basis that is the log (Lemma A), the lift route is refuted (JKSST) and exhausted here at toy scale, and the decomposition route is capped at $p^{5/6}$ (§6).
4. **Keep lattices where they are live:** the HNP / leakage line (`research/notes/lattice-hnp/`), where the next measured item is the GLV-aware lattice at cryptographic size; the automorphism fold inside the index-calculus baseline, where a constant is a constant.

The success criterion of `AGENTS.md` is a measured improvement over the index-calculus baseline; nothing in this note is one, and nothing in it is reported as one. The distance to rho for the small-x lattice route is $p^{5/6}$ against $p^{1/2}$, before the per-attempt lattice cost.

8. Sources checked

Primary sources read for this note (links or repository paths; "read" means the text was read, "abstract" means only the abstract or a secondary summary was available):

- H. W. Lenstra Jr., Complex multiplication structure of elliptic curves, J. Number Theory 56 (1996) 227–241. Read (Theorem 1). https://pub.math.leidenuniv.nl/~lenstrahw/PUBLICATIONS/1996c/art.pdf
- M. J. Jacobson, N. Koblitz, J. H. Silverman, A. Stein, E. Teske, Analysis of the xedni calculus attack, Des. Codes Cryptogr. 20 (2000) 41–64. Read (abstract, §4 asymptotic failure, §5 experiments). https://pages.cpsc.ucalgary.ca/~jacobs/PDF/xedni.pdf ; `crypto-autoresearcher:knowledge/literature/KN-LIT-021.md`.
- J. H. Silverman, The xedni calculus and the elliptic curve discrete logarithm problem, Des. Codes Cryptogr. 20 (2000). Abstract; `KN-LIT-020.md`.
- S. D. Galbraith, P. Gaudry, Recent progress on the elliptic curve discrete logarithm problem, Des. Codes Cryptogr. 78 (2016) 51–72. Read (HAL copy, hal-01215623: xedni paragraph; §"prime fields"; the conclusion on Semaev's small-abscissa base). https://hal.science/hal-01215623
- P. Gaudry, Index calculus for abelian varieties of small dimension and the elliptic curve discrete logarithm problem, J. Symb. Comput. 44 (2009). Exponent $2 - 2/n$ over F_{q^n} taken from the survey above.
- I. Semaev, New algorithm for the discrete logarithm problem on elliptic curves, arXiv:1504.01175 (2015). Read (abstract; binary-field claim under a first-fall-degree assumption, not a lattice method).

- E. Jochemsz, A. May, A strategy for finding roots of multivariate polynomials with new applications in attacking RSA variants, ASIACRYPT 2006. Basic strategy re-derived in §6 for the box polytope; the paper itself was not fetched this session.
- D. Coppersmith, Small solutions to polynomial equations, and low exponent RSA vulnerabilities, J. Cryptology 10 (1997). Univariate and bivariate bounds used as checks; `KN-LIT-037.md`.
- D. Boneh, R. Venkatesan, Hardness of computing the most significant bits of secret keys in Diffie–Hellman and related schemes, CRYPTO 1996 (`KN-LIT-043.md`); N. Howgrave-Graham, N. P. Smart, Lattice attacks on digital signature schemes, Des. Codes Cryptogr. 23 (2001) (`KN-LIT-045.md`); P. Q. Nguyen, I. E. Shparlinski, The insecurity of the elliptic curve digital signature algorithm with partially known nonces, Des. Codes Cryptogr. 30 (2003) (`KN-LIT-044.md`).
- D. Boneh, S. Halevi, N. Howgrave-Graham, The modular inversion hidden number problem, ASIACRYPT 2001 (EC-HNP); B. Shani, On the bit security of elliptic curve Diffie–Hellman, PKC 2017 (5/6 of the MSBs, rigorous; https://www.iacr.org/archive/pkc2017/101740346/101740346.pdf); J. Xu, S. Sarkar, H. Wang, L. Hu, ASIACRYPT 2022 (Coppersmith-based heuristic `1/(d+1)` fraction; https://www.iacr.org/archive/asiacrypt2022/137910066/137910066.pdf). Abstracts.
- M.-D. Huang, W. Raskind, Global duality, signature calculus and the discrete logarithm problem, LMS J. Comput. Math. 12 (2009). Abstract.
- I. Duursma, P. Gaudry, F. Morain, Speeding up the discrete log computation on curves with automorphisms, ASIACRYPT 1999; M. Wiener, R. Zuccherato, Faster attacks on elliptic curve cryptosystems, SAC 1998. Standard; constants quoted from memory of the statements.
- Repository: `KN-FIND-003/004/005/008/009/010/011`, `ledger/goals/GOAL-XEDN-00{1,2,3}.yaml`, `GOAL-ICLIFT-001.yaml` (crypto-autoresearcher); `research/notes/lattice-hnp/*`, `research/lll_degeneracy_rerun_20261016/`, `docs/ECDLP_ATTACK_MATRIX.md`, `RESEARCH_NZMS_AMS_AUSTMS_2024_IDEAS.md` §4.2, `RESEARCH_REPRESENTATION_STRUCTURE.md` (this repository).
- Repository, Coppersmith on summation polynomials (missed in the first version, added 2026-10-23): `RESEARCH_PRIME_FIELD_BREAKTHROUGH_PROGRAM.md` §2.2, §3.2 (Probe B), §3.3 (Probe C); `research/lit2026_w10_s5_coppersmith_20261011/README.md` and `examples/lit2026_w10_coppersmith_bound.rs`; `examples/prime_ecdlp_breakthrough_probe.rs`.

Gaps. Amadori–Pintore–Sala (2018, eprint 2017/609) and Petit–Kosters– Messeng (2016) were not re-read this session (eprint returned 403 through the proxy); the survey's verdict on prime-field decomposition is used in their place. No 2024–2026 paper proposing a classical lattice algorithm for the pure ECDLP was found in two searches (one extended); the recent "lattice + elliptic curve" literature is nonce-leakage HNP, quantum resource estimates, and isogeny problems (KLPT-type quaternion lattices, a different problem). A failed search is not proof that none exists.